System Architecture

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Id: `SDS-SYS-001` · Context: `system` · Kernel: `rdm/kernel/` · Composition root: `rdm/main.py` · References: `DC-001`

1 Bounded contexts

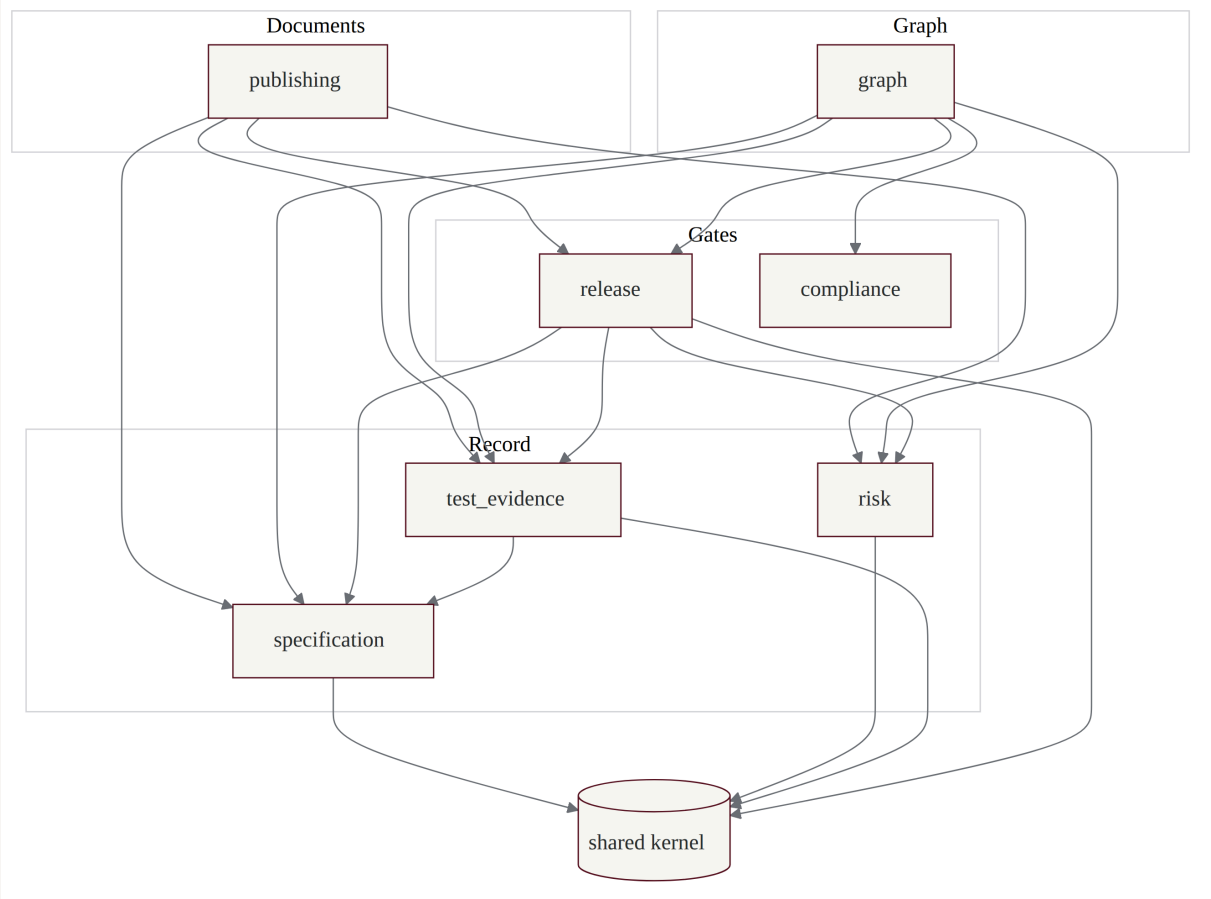
Id	Part	Layer	Code
specification	Record	2	rdm/specification/
risk	Record	1	rdm/risk/
test_evidence	Record	3	rdm/evidence/, rdm/pytest_plugin.py
release	Gates	4	rdm/release/
compliance	Gates	1	rdm/compliance/
graph	Graph	5	rdm/graph/
publishing	Documents	5	rdm/publishing/, rdm/md_extensions/

RDM audits the record of regulated software. It reads a spec as Gherkin (each scenario tagged with an id a requirement), takes the evidence of each requirement from Allure test runs, checks documents against the checklists of the standards that apply, decides whether a release may go ahead, renders regulatory documents, and builds it all into a read-only graph that people and agents query. It never authors the spec (ADR 0002).

This document holds **design only**: RDM's own requirements and user needs are its spec, written the Löyly way in `.pi/` (a slice of `.pi/plan/` per bounded context), read like any project's.

2 Context map

Each bounded context in its part; an arrow is a dependency in the code (the context imports the one it points to), downwards only, as the dependency rule requires (below).



3 The four parts

Part	Responsibility	Writes to the record?
Record	read the record: the spec (Gherkin), the risk register, validation records, checklists, test results, git	scaffolding only (`init`, `adopt`); every other change is a reviewed commit
Gates	pass/block decisions on the record	no
Graph	the knowledge graph: the record as RDF, queried and validated; agents read it over MCP (`rdm graph mcp`)	no — rebuilt from the record, never edited
Documents	regulatory documents rendered from the record	no

Only people and agents change the record, and only through a reviewed pull request; the merge is the approval. Nothing RDM derives (graph, matrix, documents, evidence bundle) is edited by hand or fed back into the record.

4 System context

Who uses RDM: a regulatory author renders documents and checks them against checklists; a team runs the gates in CI on every change; an agent reads the record through the graph's MCP server; a reviewer reads the verification report and the evidence bundle. RDM runs as the `rdm` command, as a pytest plugin inside a project's acceptance run, and as reusable CI (a GitHub workflow and actions). It depends on git, on Allure results written by the project's test runner, and, to render PDFs, on Pandoc and Typst.

5 Bounded contexts (one design document each), by part

A bounded context is drawn where the language changes, not where the workflow does (`CONTEXT.md`): the stages of a requirement's life (written, verified, released) are not contexts. The code of each context is in the frontmatter (`code`).

Part	Context	Design document	Its language	Package
Record	`specification` (core)	`design/specification.md`	spec, slice, scenario, requirement, user need, surface, screen	`rdm/specification/`: the Gherkin reader, the spec's configuration, the Löyly adapter, `init`, `adopt`, validation records
Record	`risk`	`design/risk.md`	hazard, harm, severity, probability, control, residual	`rdm/risk/`
Record	`test_evidence`	`design/test_evidence.md`	test run, executor, step, attachment, tag; Allure's words stop here	`rdm/evidence/`: Allure results; and

Part	Context	Design document	Its language	Package
				`rdm/pytest_plugin.py`
Gates	`release`	`design/release.md`	verified, release gate, finding	`rdm/release/`: the release gate, the verification data; and the reusable CI
Gates	`compliance`	`design/compliance.md`	standard, checklist, checklist clause, gap, coverage	`rdm/compliance/`
Graph	`graph`	`design/graph.md`	knowledge graph, projection, vocabulary, gate rule	`rdm/graph/`: the projection, the shapes, the SPARQL endpoint and the MCP server
Documents	`publishing`	`design/publishing.md`	template, data, rendered document, evidence bundle	`rdm/publishing/`: render, snippets, DMR index, the verification report, the evidence bundle; and `rdm/md_extensions/` and the PDF action

Not contexts: the **shared kernel** (`rdm/kernel/`: YAML and file helpers, EDN, ids, git, frontmatter, the reconcile helpers), below every context; and the **composition root** (`rdm/main.py`), which wires the command line to every context. Onboarding (`init`, `adopt`) is the specification's application layer. Three paths users name stay where they are: `rdm/main.py` (the `rdm` command), `rdm/pytest_plugin.py` (imported by a project's `conftest.py`) and `rdm/md_extensions/` (named in a project's `config.yml`).

6 Dependency rule

A context imports only contexts of a lower layer, and the shared kernel; nothing imports a context of the top layer. The layers and each context's code are in the frontmatter, and a test fails on any import that breaks the rule, and on any module no context's code holds (`tests/dependency_rule_test.py`).

```
 5  publishing · graph              read models: read every context, feed none back
 4  release                         decides: verified status, risk and validation →
release
 3  test_evidence                   translates Allure results into runs of the spec's
requirements
 2  specification                   the core: the spec read as Gherkin, needs,
requirements
 1  risk · compliance               leaves: their own languages, nothing but the
kernel
 0  shared kernel                   util · edn · ids · git · frontmatter · reconcile
```

The leaves sit below the core because the core uses them and they use nothing: the release gate applies the risk rules, and neither leaf reads a requirement. The evidence bundle renders the matrix and the verification report, so it is publishing's, and realises release's item-04-003.

7 Flow

The spec → its evidence (Allure runs) and its risks → the release gate decides, and gap analysis holds the documents to their checklists → the knowledge graph and the documents are derived from the same record. Agent skills (how to author requirements, test-first, risk analysis) are maintained outside RDM, in `scope-impact/agent-skills`. RDM ships no planning tooling: tasks and issues live in their own tools, outside the record (see `docs/about/plan-vs-record.md`).

8 Not yet in scope

In rough order: turning a regulation into a checklist mapped to its standard's clauses; pushing the graph to an external RDF store, with the vocabulary and gate shapes versioned; and several projects in one graph (clause identifiers are already project-independent). Each enters through a user need and requirements in the spec before any code.